

Leheng Zhang

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[Personal Homepage](#) [Google Scholar](#) [GitHub](#)



EDUCATION

South China Normal University
Computer Science and Technology (Junior)

Guangzhou, Guangdong
Sep. 2023–Present

- ▷ GPA: 4.02/5.0.
- ▷ Major rank: 1/160 (top 0.6%).
- ▷ Ranked 2nd in the comprehensive assessment in the freshman year and 1st in the sophomore year.
- ▷ English proficiency: CET-4: 647; CET-6: 571; IELTS: 7.0.
- ▷ Honors: First-Class Outstanding Student Scholarship for Full-Time Undergraduates, School of Computer Science, South China Normal University (2023–2024 and 2024–2025); Second Prize, Undergraduate Student Innovation Award, South China Normal University (2024).

University of British Columbia
International Visiting Student

Vancouver, Canada
Jul. 2024–Aug. 2024

- ▷ Course 1: “Music: An introduction to Electrical & Computer Engineering.”
- ▷ Course 2: “Music Laboratory: Hands on Learning.”

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Targeted Drug Research for Epstein–Barr Virus

Jun. 2025–Jan. 2026

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University (in collaboration with Academician Musheng Zeng’s team at Sun Yat-sen University Cancer Center).
- ▷ Used diffusion models to develop targeted drugs against the DBD or other regions of the EBNA1 protein.

Multimodal Computing

May 2025–Present

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University.
- ▷ Used pretrained language models and multimodal large language models for multimodal sentiment analysis.
- ▷ 1 paper accepted at ACM Multimedia, 1 at Interspeech (Oral), 1 first-author paper under review at Information Fusion, 1 first-author manuscript under revision, and 1 paper under review at AAAI.
- **Leheng Zhang**, Manning Gao, Menghua Jiang, Yuxia Lin, Haifeng Hu, Yewen Huang, Sijie Mai*. PRISM: Primary-Centric Multimodal Fusion with Information Bottlenecks and Confidence-Aware Gating. *Information Fusion*, 2026. (Under Review)
- **Leheng Zhang**, Liyuan Pan, Manning Gao, Xueyi Wang, Yuxia Lin, Sijie Mai*. RITHM: Recursive Information-Theoretic Halting for Multimodal Sentiment Understanding. (Manuscript under revision)
- Manning Gao, **Leheng Zhang**, Shiqin Han, Haifeng Hu, Yuncheng Jiang, Sijie Mai*. GRCF: Group-wise Ranking and Calibration Framework for Multimodal Sentiment Analysis. In: *Proceedings of ACM Multimedia*, 2026. (Accepted)
- Manning Gao, Tingyi Liu, **Leheng Zhang**, Haifeng Hu, Yuncheng Jiang, Sijie Mai*. Uncovering Latent Depression Severity for Binary Depression Detection via Advantage-weighting Ranking. In: *Proceedings of Interspeech*, 2026. (Accepted, Oral)
- Menghua Jiang, **Leheng Zhang**, Yuncheng Jiang, Haifeng Hu, Sijie Mai*. Deconfounding Multimodal Affective Computing via Minimal Global Causal Representations (CaMIB). *Proceedings of AAAI*, 2027. (Under Review)

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

Guangzhou Fengxin Intelligent Technology Co., Ltd. (Algorithm Intern)

Apr. 2025–Aug. 2025

- ▷ Participated in the development and testing of a massage-chair speech model, applying algorithms and engineering skills to a real product project.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Security Vulnerability Detection Tool for Linux Kernel Code

Jan. 2026–Present

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Dingding Li, South China Normal University.
- ▷ Developed a security vulnerability detection tool for Linux kernel code as a core member, covering design, development, and iteration for automated detection and analysis of potential vulnerabilities.
- ▷ Used this project in multiple competitions and received First Prize in the National College Student Computer System Capability Competition—Operating System Design Contest (South China Regional), Second Prize in the China Collegiate Computer Design Contest (Guangdong Provincial), Second Prize in the China Collegiate Computing Contest—Network Technology Challenge (South China Regional), and an Award of Excellence in the National College Student Information Security Contest.

Embodied-AI Robotic Arm for Playing Board Games

Dec. 2024

- ▷ Advisor: Prof. Sijie Mai, South China Normal University.
- ▷ Debugged the robotic arm, fine-tuned large models, and studied robotic-arm control to enable the arm to play Gomoku, Go, and similar board games.
- ▷ Developed an LLM-driven board-game-playing robotic arm; the related software was granted computer software copyright registration.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Research interests: Multimodal computing, embodied intelligence, and AI for Science.
Plan to pursue doctoral studies.